



middle-order, Pujara (right) and Rahane, who last featured in India's defeat to Australia in the World Test Championship final in June last year, seem to have run out of rope. With young talent coming into its own in the England series, a smooth transition is underway, and perhaps the need of the hour.

But the closing stages of the league stage also coincided with a stern warning for the youngsters from BCCI secretary Jay Shah, who urged centrally contracted players to back their aspirations of representing India with regular appearances on the domestic circuit.

Ishan Kishan, Shreyas Iyer and Deepak Chahar



PTI

Left is right: Left-arm spinners Sai Kishore and S. Ajith Ram (in pic) were also key architects of TN's uptick in First Class cricket, with the duo picking up 76 wickets between them.

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have reportedly also incurred the wrath of the administration in the wake of this decree. Though Iyer was unavailable for Mumbai's final league game against Assam, reportedly due to a back issue, Shardul Thakur marked his presence with a 10-wicket haul in his side's innings-victory.

Though reiterating the importance of performances on the domestic circuit is a welcome move, the BCCI will also have to do its part